

Mega-wealthy deal maker at center of Harvard talks

Schwarzman has ties to higher education and Trump

By Aidan Ryan and Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Roughly 60 years ago, Stephen A. Schwarzman picked up the phone and tried to persuade Harvard College's dean of admissions to take him off the wait-list.

"I think I'm going to be very successful and that would be good for Harvard," Schwarzman, in a 2019 interview, recalled telling the dean.

While he couldn't persuade Harvard to change its decision (Schwarzman wound up as a Yale undergrad), he made good on his vow of success in the 1980s by cofounding the Blackstone Group, one of the world's largest investment firms. Now, Schwarzman is seeking to make good on the other half of his promise by helping Harvard resolve its existential standoff with the Trump administration.

Schwarzman has become a key go-between as the two sides resume talks to restore Harvard's funding and resolve a litany of federal charges, many of which came after the university rejected sweeping demands to overhaul its governance, admissions, and hiring. But they have yet to reach an agree-

► **Harvard administrators say majority of research grants have been restored. B1.**

ment, despite President Trump's repeated declarations that a deal is close to being finalized.

Schwarzman is now engaging in negotiations on Harvard's behalf, according to a White House official who spoke on the condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak publicly. The New York Times first reported the financial executive's involvement last week.

A spokesperson for Blackstone declined to comment on behalf of Schwarzman, and a spokesperson for Harvard also declined to comment. But a review of Schwarzman's business record and his

SCHWARZMAN, Page A7

Mills joins race in Maine for Senate seat held by Collins

By James Pindell
GLOBE STAFF

Maine Governor Janet Mills, a Democrat, launched her campaign for the Senate on Tuesday, seeking the seat held by Republican incumbent Susan Collins. The race is poised to become not only one of the most closely watched contests in next year's midterm elections, but also perhaps be the Democrats' best opportunity to flip a Senate seat anywhere in the country.

Mills, 77, enters what is already a crowded Democratic primary field. Beyond her higher name recognition, she emphasized in an interview with the Globe her record of winning.

"None of them have ever won an election. I have. I won two statewide races," said Mills of her primary opponents. "I'm the only person in this race who has delivered for the Maine people. I am the only person in this race who has actually stood up to Donald Trump. I believe I can win this primary and this election and turn things around."

Indeed, Mills is the only Democrat to have won statewide in Maine in the past two decades. It is also true that if she is successful, Mills will be 79 when she starts her term, making her the oldest incoming senator in history. Collins, 72, would be seeking her sixth Senate term. She has yet to officially declare she is running again, though she told reporters she intends to run.

MILLS, Page A6

Return of remains moves slowly

Israel says cease-fire being violated; Hamas points to widespread destruction of Gaza



LEO CORREA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Israeli excavators operated in the Gaza Strip on Tuesday. The Israeli government reportedly has been weighing measures to penalize Hamas for not turning over more bodies immediately.

By Liam Stack and Aaron Boxerman
NEW YORK TIMES

TEL AVIV — Israeli officials and hostage families have accused Hamas of violating the new cease-fire deal by failing to immediately return the remains of many of the former captives still in the Gaza Strip.

The truce agreement called for the immediate handover of all remaining bodies in Gaza, but acknowledged that some could be difficult to locate and may take more time to retrieve because of the destruction. Gaza was highly urbanized before the war, but two years of Israeli strikes have turned large parts of it into a flattened landscape of cement rubble.

On Monday, Hamas returned

four bodies out of the roughly two dozen remaining, angering Israelis who had been expecting many more to come home. But late Tuesday, the Israeli military said it had been informed that the Red Cross received four more coffins with the remains of hostages.

A statement from the prime minister's office around midnight said that Israeli forces had received those remains and that they were being transferred to Israel for identification. After the identification process, families will be notified, it said.

The Israeli government has been weighing measures to penalize Hamas for not turning over more bodies, according to two diplomats briefed by Israeli

MIDEAST, Page A5

'I believed because of him. He gave me the motivation. He gave me the faith.'

MARIAN MERRIMAN, *speaking about her son Rickey "FuQuan" McGee*

AFTER THREE DECADES, FREE AT LAST



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

It was a moment Rickey "FuQuan" McGee had long waited for, as he was released from prison Tuesday after being incarcerated for 28 years in the murder of a convenience store clerk in 1997. Amid questions about evidence and whether McGee had a fair trial, prosecutors now agreed that the conviction should be vacated and that McGee should have a new trial. If he's granted one, they will move to drop the charges against him, they said. **B1.**

For borrowers, payback gets even worse

Students with ballooning debt caught in an impenetrable system

By Mara Kardas-Nelson and Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

Jackie Daniels did what she could to keep the cost of college low. The child of two Postal Service workers, she chose a state college in Connecticut over a private university and worked as a resident assistant throughout to keep room and board costs down.

To cover the balance, she took out \$40,000 in federal student loans, money that she's been trying to repay since she graduated in 2020. But understanding how to do so hasn't been easy.

Federal loan repayments were paused during the pandemic and restarted in an era of high inflation and economic uncertainty. Then President Joe Biden's SAVE Plan



LUIS G. RENDON/GLOBE STAFF; WESLEY LAPOINTE FOR THE WASHINGTON POST; GERALD HERBERT/ASSOCIATED PRESS; DOUG MILLS/NEW YORK TIMES

lowered her monthly payments. But that was challenged in court.

Now, under President Trump, the program ends in 2028, with in-

terest accruals already resumed. For all borrowers, the number of repayment options has been limit-

STUDENT LOANS, Page A6

Fenway Health limits care for trans patients under age 19

By Marin Wolf and Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

Fenway Health, one of the major providers of gender-affirming care in Boston, will no longer offer hormones or puberty blockers to transgender patients under age 19 following a change to federal funding requirements.

The community clinic, which specializes in LGBTQ+ care, announced the change Monday afternoon in a letter to patients. The new limitations in care for teen patients are necessary to remain in compliance with the Health Resources and Services Administration, the clinic said.

Fenway Health, which treats more than 30,000 patients, is a Federally Qualified Health Center, meaning it provides medical services regardless of patients' ability to pay. It could lose its FQHC designation and funding if found out of compliance with federal rules.

"This change in position is a response to a shifting federal landscape that requires us to

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Governor Maura Healey urged the top utility regulator to review charges on residents' gas and electric bills and remove any that aren't justified. **B1.**

A sharp slowdown in hiring poses a growing risk to the economy, Fed Reserve chair Jerome Powell said. **B5.**

State lawmakers proposed



holding back more than \$100 million for county sheriffs' offices, citing "questionable spending practices." **B1.**

Devra First gets a real taste of Texas at Blondie's Barbecue in Walpole (left, a pulled pork sandwich). **G1.**

The United States struck again in the Caribbean, killing six men allegedly carrying drugs. **A3.**

Northeastern hockey captain Lily Shannon says her hearing loss has never been an issue. **C1.**

Roll of the dry

Wednesday: Sun's back. High 60-65. Low 41-46.

Thursday: Sun's gone. High 53-58. Low 43-48. High tide: 7:01 a.m., 7:17 p.m. Sunrise: 6:57 Sunset: 6:02

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.